



Integrated BBA-MBA

1st Year

Summer Internship I

Final Report

Internship at:





Name: Archishman Das
Roll no. 24BBA471
Batch: I BBA-MBA 24-29
Year: 1st year

Company of Internship:



Report Purpose: Final Report for Summer Internship

Submitted for: Internship Evaluation and Grading

Submitted To: Prof. Ritu Raj

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

For this internship, I would like to thank my college, Institute of Management, Nirma University for adding such skill building and experiential learning option into the curriculum. I would thank the BBA Placement Committee for handling all processes and documentations required by the Organisation for the internship opportunity. I would thank the Programme Chain and my Faculty Mentor for guiding me and providing all required instructions and guidelines for the internship process, both before and after commencement.

I would like to thank my mentor at Child Rights and You (CRY) organisation, Ms. Rubina Haque for her continuous communication with the interns and assignments of tasks and centre visits. I would also like to thank Field Coordinator Ms. Swagata, Community Mobilizer Mr. Rahim and other CRY teachers and staff for the guidance, support and communication.

I would like to thank the Communities and the Children who allowed me to be a part of their lives for a short period. The friendly nature of the children made the internship and teaching experience enjoyable as well as a huge learning experience.

I would like to thank my family for their constant support, my batchmates and friends for recommendations and guidance and my internship colleagues for a productive, conductive and collaborative learning environment.

ABSTRACT

This report details an experiential learning internship with Child Rights and You (CRY) at their Akanksha field in Kolkata, focusing on child education in underprivileged areas. The intern observed community conditions, children's progress, and compiled reports contrasting government data with on-ground realities. Key observations highlight CRY's significant impact in preventing child labor, fostering inclusive communities, and addressing educational disparities despite government limitations. The internship provided valuable insights into child rights issues, community engagement, and report compilation, emphasizing the crucial role of NGOs in driving social change and holistic child development.

PART A: PROFILE OF ORGANIZATION

About the Organization:

Started in 1979, CRY – Child Rights and You is a top NGO in India working for underprivileged children. It has been working towards creating happier and healthier childhoods for more than four decades. With its headquarters in Mumbai, CRY has offices in top cities in India: Delhi, Bangalore, and Kolkata. Being the best child rights NGO in India, it is committed to doing everything it can to ensure the rights of India's children – right to education, safety & protection, health & nutrition and participation.

CRY is recognized as one of the most trusted NGOs in India. Through its 144 projects spread across 20 states in India, CRY works on the issues of: child education, health & nutrition, child labour and child marriage. CRY NGO addresses the critical needs of children by working with parents, teachers, Anganwadi workers, communities, district and state-level governments as well as the children themselves to create a sustainable change. In the last 4 decades, with the support of generous donors, CRY one of the best charities in India, has positively impacted the lives of over 4.7 million children.

About the Members:

Child Rights and You Foundation was founded by Mr. Rippan Kapur, a middle-class guy with an ordinary life, who wanted to bring extraordinary change. He started CRY with 6 friends and just Rs. 50 in 1979. Rippan Kapur was an ordinary person who dared to dream of a better future for India's children. He envisioned an India where no child was deprived of basic rights and a childhood filled with happiness and opportunities.

Ms. Puja Marwaha has been the CEO of CRY for the last 10 years. After completing her HR from Xavier Institute of Social Service (XISS), Puja wanted to put her HR skills to good use, and made the transition from corporate to social sector early in her career. That's when she joined CRY in 1994. Over the last 26 years with CRY, Puja has played a major role in the NGO's development. Her work is focused on creating an organisational framework that

attempts to better the approach towards children, and make a change in the lives of underprivileged children. She is also on the board for VANI – Voluntary Action Network India – in an endeavour to strengthen public mobilisation for social causes.

Child Rights and You Vision: A happy, healthy and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured in a society that is built on respect for dignity, justice and equity for all.

Child Rights and You Mission:

Taking Responsibility: To enable people to take responsibility for the situation of the deprived Indian child and so motivate them to seek resolution through individual and collective action thereby enabling children to realise their full potential

Mobilising Potential: To make people discover their potential for action and change

Inspiring Collective Action: To enable peoples' collectives and movements encompassing diverse segments, to pledge their particular strengths, working in partnership to secure, protect and honour the rights of India's children.

CRY Impact:

- 22,63,435 children impacted overall
- 95% children in CRY project areas, between the ages of 6-18 years, in school
- 98% children in CRY project areas, under the age of 5 years, protected from undernourishment
- 99% of adolescent girls, in CRY project areas, between 11-18 years, protected from child marriage
- 85% children, in CRY project areas, between the ages of 6-18 years, protected from child labour

PART B: DETAILS OF A PROJECT WORK

Experiential Learning Project (Type–III)

INTRODUCTION

Child Rights and You works for the Protection of Rights and Empowerment of Children. CRY works in most parts of India with permanent fields, awareness campaigns, public actions groups and educational drives and rallies.

My internship was at Akanksha, a field dedicated to education of children in certain underprivileged areas of Kolkata. Two centres in the fields educated dozens of children for free as well as provides other skills like dancing, self-defence and art and craft. My work was to understand the communities, understand the progress and current condition of the children and create a report from my observations. I also interacted with the children, participated in events together and taught some batches alongside CRY staff.

OBSERVATIONS:

As a hybrid intern at CRY, I had both online reports and presentations to build as well as field visits to create my own observations and information from. I learned about overall CRY impact and campaigns through the topics given to me for online reports. I had to write reports to compare the government and international organization data to the on-ground reality. I was also given the task to summarize and combine multiple reports from a CRY Public Action Group and their campaigns.

Journal Entries:

Understanding the communities and the children was the most important task for my internship as explained by CRY staff and mentor. As a part of that I took regular walks and visits to the fields and observed as much as I could of the communities without interfering in their day to day lives or causing a both. Certain observations were explained by CRY staff and some seemed to stem from the condition and history of the communities.

Certain observations made were:

Organisation Image from Inside: The staff at cry explained to me the real changes they have seen over the years of working there. They do not claim to be very close to their goals but certainly on the right track. The teachers explain that their main goal has been to prevent the children in underprivileged areas from having to go to work at a young age which hinders their studies or completely ends their education early.

Organisation's Image about the Communities: The staff commented that the communities are quite accepting and open. The fields are surrounded by mixed communities, people of all religions, castes, cultures and also people from other states live and work in those areas alongside one another. This creates a unique culture in the region which is highly inclusive and welcoming. The children of the community do not differentiate among one another but are friends regardless of the backgrounds or households. The children are also quite excited whenever they see a newcomer at CRY as they do not get to see new faces much often, being limited to their regions because of economic condition.

Educational Capability of the Children: At CRY I interacted with children of all ages from class I to class XII. One point mentioned by the CRY staff as well as observed by me was that the capability of the children could not be judged from their current class in school. A class 9 student may have the capability as expected from their age or much lower capability, as low as that of a class II student. This made following a curriculum or fixed classroom schedules difficult. Children had to be personally taught and improved to have them catch up with the others. Some students were very motivated to study and performed quite well, including in their Board Examinations.

Status of the Communities: Members of the community have been part of it for multiple generations. Most of the people living there are financially weak and want future generations to progress in life, however, owing to their struggles sometimes they are forced to get their children into work for an extra earning hand. Most of the families live in one room homes which can be smaller than 10 sq. feet in size. Hence, the children spend a vast majority of their time outside, on the streets, playing or roaming around. This results in higher chances of bad influence, roadside life risks and a loss in interest towards education.

Goals of the Children: Some of the children, who are focused on studies, have big dreams for their lives. They don't always have all the information about career opportunities or scopes for

education but they put their whole effort into their school exams and some perform very well. Some girls show interest in joining Indian Armed Forces and some boys show interest in business and industry creation. Sometimes their skills and passion can be wasted due to lack of opportunity awareness. That is why organizations like CRY and government initiatives are important to lead the students on the right tracks and introduce them to all the career paths available to them.

Organization Opinion about the Children: CRY staff believe that almost all the children have huge potential when they show eagerness to learn. However, a big challenge in their programme is to explain to the children and their families the importance of education. Children might often skip classes, have low attendance or spend their time away from studying, in such cases the teachers and staff have to follow up and request the families to restart sending their children for their studies. The children study in Government Schools, but the communities mostly speak Hindi as a result of being very mixed in nature, while the schools are run by State Board in Bengali language. This creates a divide between teachers and students which has to be filled through external support like coaching and social organizations like CRY.

Contrast between Government Data and Ground Reality: Government data claims huge initiatives and campaigns by the government have lifted up the underprivileged families and children. However, CRY staff say that it is the collaborative work by Non-Governmental Organizations and funding by private individuals that made the real change. Over the last three decades there has been significant and observable change in the mindset and condition of the children of these communities, but the Government involvement in that change is little to none. The funding received from government is usually slow, too little and often plagued with bureaucratic lag and issues. The children who do perform well, leave their homes in search of better opportunities, and the children who stay work on improving the condition of their families. Their efforts have proven to be a force of change and a right step towards progress of the underprivileged.

Critical Issues:

- CRY functions in almost all “Red-light areas” in Kolkata and other major cities. The mothers of most children in those regions are involved in sex work industry. The organizations have to work tirelessly to prevent the children from getting involved in the exploitative industry, especially the girls. The rate of trafficking and crimes against

women in such areas also widely go unreported to police or to government, but the organizations report significant decrease in such crimes over the last few decades. The sex work is also done from their homes, meaning the children often have to spend evenings or nights outside. CRY provides them a secure place to rest and study. Otherwise, they would face severe risk to their safety and deterioration to their mental health.

- It is crucial that the children do not skip classes for too long or lose communication with the organization. There are still chances that children above a certain age will be put to work to earn from the family. That eventually deteriorates their interest in studies and makes it difficult to bring them back. The friendly nature of the children also means that they are prone to risks from strangers and wrong influence. Risking their exploitation or someone getting them into substance abuse and addiction.
- The communities being mixed provides a diverse background to learn from, but at the same time, these regions are sensitive to political issues and violent situations from time to time. In such cases it becomes risky and even dangerous for the younger children and may unwillingly involve the older children in demonstrations or protests. Shielding the children from such dangers becomes a responsibility of the organizations because the Government and Police often doesn't send immediate help.

CONCLUSION

Trends in the Organization: The organization and its members work tirelessly for the growth and development of the children. They use creative teaching methods and motivate the children based on their skills. Campaigns and special events are conducted frequently to keep a lively environment and change of pace. The organization is creating a positive change in the communities and lives of the children. Not just through education but through a holistic growth of the children, with art and craft, dancing and music classes as well as self defence course for both boys and girls. The staff show up to work regardless of if they are tired or sick, showing a strong passion for the purpose and dedication towards the children.

Feedback given to Organization: To keep an eye on online activities of the children. Internet is dangerous and many can get trapped, or exploited. Although difficult, introducing the students to the abilities and dangers of Artificial Intelligence as early as possible is crucial. The children have to be as isolated as possible from political issues and unrests. The teachers and

staff are very friendly and approachable. They looked to it that I could experience as many things as possible within the 4 weeks I had which helped in my experience and knowledge of the societal causes and actions taken.

Self-Learning: Learned about several issues that plague the underprivileged to this day. Gained knowledge about mixed communities. Witnessed for the first time the lives of sex workers and their families. Learned how to support children and look to protect their Rights. Learned the progress as well as the current issues regarding Child Rights and Child Empowerment. Learned to interact and collaborate with organisations and communities to provide whatever help I can.

1. Understanding the Movements: I participated on movements that expanded not only my experiences but also a lesson in why initiatives outside the classroom are equally important. Children and students learn about more worldwide issues and expand an awareness campaign that can benefit multiple generations.

- Environment Day is an important day to learn for the younger generation. Knowing about the climate, the damage it has faced, and how we can protect the environment is important for the next generation as they will have to take responsibility for the environment soon.
- We went door to door for the Anti Child Labour campaigns. It is an all-important mission. For the establishment of Child Rights, for the growth of families and careers and for a bright future for the children of the underprivileged.

2. Learned about CRY organisation

- Learned about how CRY organises events and campaigns. How CRY works not just to educate children but also spread awareness among the wider community and its people. The events have to be planned days or weeks in advanced. The preparations involve not just staff but also the students. Sometimes on spot planning and presence of mind is also required for better execution and effect.
- Going through the report taught me the day-to-day effect of such organisations. The Action Groups by CRY alone has helped tens of thousands of students all over the country. Being part of such initiatives and programs opens up ideas, opportunities and willingness to do more for people around me.

PART C: LEARNINGS FROM THE INTERNSHIP

During my experiential learning internship with Muskaan Foundation for Road Safety, I realized development well beyond technical skill or day-to-day responsibilities. I explored roles that demanded not simply head skills, but empathic human aware skills, creative skill, governance and leadership, and resilience. What began as an exciting summer internship became a remarkable and powerful experience for me in civic awareness and responsibility.

1. Building Social Skills:

- Interacted with people of many age groups and background. Improved my social skills and reduced social nervousness. I was able to freely communicate in multiple languages depending on the convenience of CRY staff and children improving my fluency and translational vocabulary.
- Conversations in such a new sphere expanded my vision and outlook about social issues. An ability to understand the on-ground realities of some communities and varying action by government initiative and non-governmental organizations.

2. Research and Analysis

- Made a presentation comparing government reports and goals to on ground progress and observations. Giving me experience in a comparative format of report building and presentation.
- Summarized Public Action Group reports into one presentation and learned to create more efficient and approachable content. Giving me experience in summarization and compilation type of presentation and report generation.
- Continued to take notes. Discussed my overall observations with the CRY staff and teachers and also took their review of my performance and participation. Improving my journaling and observation skills.

3. **Planning and Creativity at the Grassroot Level:** The truth about grassroots work is that it generally isn't easy. It is not uncommon to experience days of non-compliance from survey respondents, days of heat-stricken campaigning, and days when we just couldn't seem to get the link between our ideas and actions right. Yet, there were

teaching moments through each of those experiences be it flexibility, collaboration, and troubleshooting. Grassroots work has a pedagogy to it; it isn't going to look perfect, but it has the possibility of creating the most meaningful impact--we are not just drawn to creative learning, but also to learning from those experiences. Last second changes in plans, not being respected by the public are all irritating but gives us a lot of strength for the future.

4. **Empathy and Action:** Every interaction, every discussion, added to a greater understanding. Talking with sex workers increased my awareness of occupational vulnerabilities and systemic neglect. Training sessions with children helped me understand the value of learning for children and why supporting the ones lagging behind is essential.

The PAG report compilation gave me a look into the live effect of the organisations and their programmes. Everyday people are working for the benefit of the country and its people and it is an honour to be a part of the journey.

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ANNEXURE – A

INTERNSHIP AND CAMPAIGN PHOTOS



Anti-Child Labour Rally on
12th of June



Environment Day
Awareness Walk on 5th June



Interaction and Teaching Session
with Kids during Field Visit



Self Defence Classes for all Students

INTERNSHIP COMPLETION CERTIFICATE



Date: -16-06-2025

TO WHOM SO EVER IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that **Mr. Archisman Das** had interned with **CRY-Child Rights and You** from **12th May to 12th June 2025**.

During the tenure of his internship, he has undertaken various assignments:

- Participated actively in CRY events and campaigns
- Prepared a holistic understanding on Child Rights and CRY's alignment with it via field visits, Interaction with children and project coordinators and data collection.
- During his field visit he has interacted and taught children
- Content Writing: Preparing detailed reports via compilation of PPTs on our Public Action Group.

Archisman has been an excellent performer throughout his internship. We found him to be a sincere and a diligent individual.

We wish him all the best for future endeavours!

Regards,



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